VICTORY 2026

English

The Pedestrian
(Part-1)

Lecture - 07

By – Nupur Ma'am



Topics *to be covered*

1. Overview
2. Line by line Explanation
3. Word-Meanings
4. Summary, Theme, Ques-Answers, MCQs





Topic: Overview

Ray Bradbury, the author of the story, ***'The Pedestrian',*** was an American writer and screenwriter, known predominantly for his work in the science fiction genre. Bradbury's works have also been adapted into numerous television shows, films and stage productions.

'The Pedestrian' also showcases Bradbury's knack for social commentary, which is a recurring aspect throughout his body of work. The story presents a dystopian future where individuality and human connection have been largely eroded, replaced by an almost robotic and homogeneous society. It is a critique of the growing influence of technology, media consumption and the possible loss of human individuality and creativity.

Written in 1951





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

To enter out into that silence that was the city at eight o'clock of a misty evening in November, to put your feet upon that buckling concrete walk, to step over grassy seams and make your way, hands in pockets, through the silences, that was what Mr. Leonard Mead most dearly loved to do.

foggy

Collapsing

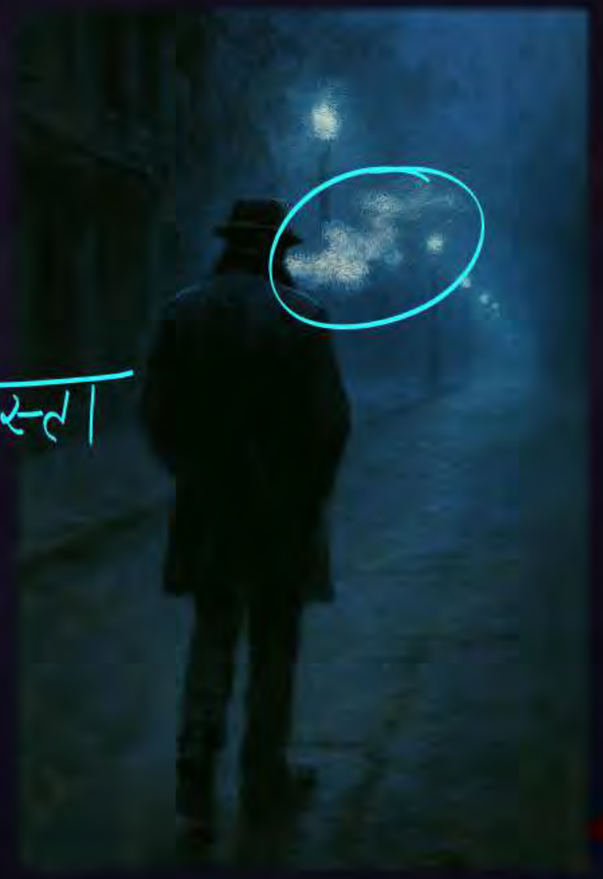
sideways walkway made of cement

functions



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

He would stand upon the corner of an intersection and peer down long moonlit avenues of sidewalks in four directions, deciding which way to go, but it really made no difference; he was alone in this world of A.D. 2053, or as good as alone, and with a final decision made, a path selected, he would stride off, sending patterns of frosty air before him like the smoke of a cigar.





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury



Sometimes he would walk for hours and miles and return only at midnight to his house. And on his way he would see the cottages and homes with their dark windows, and it was not unequal to walking through a graveyard where only the faintest glimmers of firefly light appeared in flickers behind the windows.

burial ground

flashes

It was like Ingnu

flashes

Sudden grey phantoms seemed to manifest upon inner room walls where a curtain was still undrawn against the night, or there were whisperings and murmurs where a window in a tomb-like building was still open.

ghosts

appear

not closed

low sounds

House - tomb (an underground place to bury the dead)
(like Taj Mahal



Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. Mr. Mead would return from his walks only at _____.

A sunrise

B dusk

C noon

D midnight

Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. What activity would Mr. Mead do for hours?

A. Painting

B. Running

C. Walking

D. Reading



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

Mr. Leonard Mead would pause, cock his head, listen, look, and march on, his feet making no noise on the lumpy walk. For long ago he had wisely changed to sneakers when strolling at night, because the dogs in intermittent squads would parallel his journey with barkings if he wore hard heels, and lights might click on and faces appear and an entire street by startled by the passing of a lone figure, himself, in the early November evening.





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

On this particular evening, he began his journey in a westerly direction, toward the hidden sea. There was a good crystal frost in the air; it cut the nose and made the lungs blaze like a Christmas tree inside; you could feel the cold light going on and off, all the branches filled with invisible snow. He listened to the faint push of his soft shoes through the autumn leaves with satisfaction, and whistled a cold quiet whistle between his teeth, occasionally picking up a leaf as he passed, examining its skeletal pattern in the infrequent lamplights as he went on, smelling its rusty smell.





Moonlit avenues → चांद से रोशन सड़के

Notice / E-mail / Letter, Composition

- Specimen Paper 2025, 2026

PYQs → literature → 2025

language - 2020 - 2025

Pedestrian → पैदल यात्री



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"Hello, in there," he whispered to every house on every side as he moved. *"What's up tonight on Channel 4, Channel 7, Channel 9? Where are the cowboys rushing, and do I see the United States Cavalry over the next hill to the rescue?"*

soldiers

बचाने के लिए

(Random)

Villagers





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury



Simile (@1st)

The street was silent and long and empty, with only his shadow moving like the shadow of a hawk in mid-country. If he closed his eyes and stood very still, frozen, he could imagine himself upon the centre of a plain, a wintry, windless Arizona desert with no house in a thousand miles, and only dry river beds, the streets, for company.

deserted area

Stop moving

dry rivers

"What is it now?" he asked the houses, noticing his wrist watch. ***"Eight-thirty pm? Time for a dozen assorted murders? A quiz? A revue? A comedian falling off the stage?"***

mixed



Revue: a theatrical performance dealing with topical issues



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

Was that a murmur of laughter from within the moon-white house? He hesitated, but went on when nothing happened. He stumbled over a particularly uneven section of sidewalk. The cement was vanishing under flowers and grass. In ten years of walking by night or day, for thousands of miles, he had never met another person walking, not once in all that time.

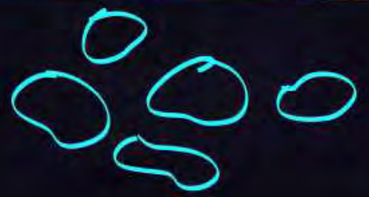




Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

He came to a cloverleaf intersection which stood silent where two main highways crossed the town. During the day it was a thunderous surge of cars, the gas stations open, a great insect rustling and a ceaseless jockeying for position as the scarab-beetles, a faint incense puttering from their exhausts, skimmed homeward to the far directions. But now these highways, too, were like streams in a dry season, all stone and bed and moon radiance.

Sudden movements
competing
petrol pump
Continuous
smell
river
moving
a type of insect like dung beetles
coming out
Simile
brightness



A crossing in the shape of a clover leaf for smooth movement of traffic



Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. How did the city feel to Mr. Mead?

at night

A. Loud and bustling

B. Crowded and chaotic

C. Warm and inviting

D. Silent and empty

Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. What was the general state of the houses Mr. Mead passed by on his walks?

A. They were brightly lit with families visible inside.

B. They were dark with the occasional flicker of a television screen.

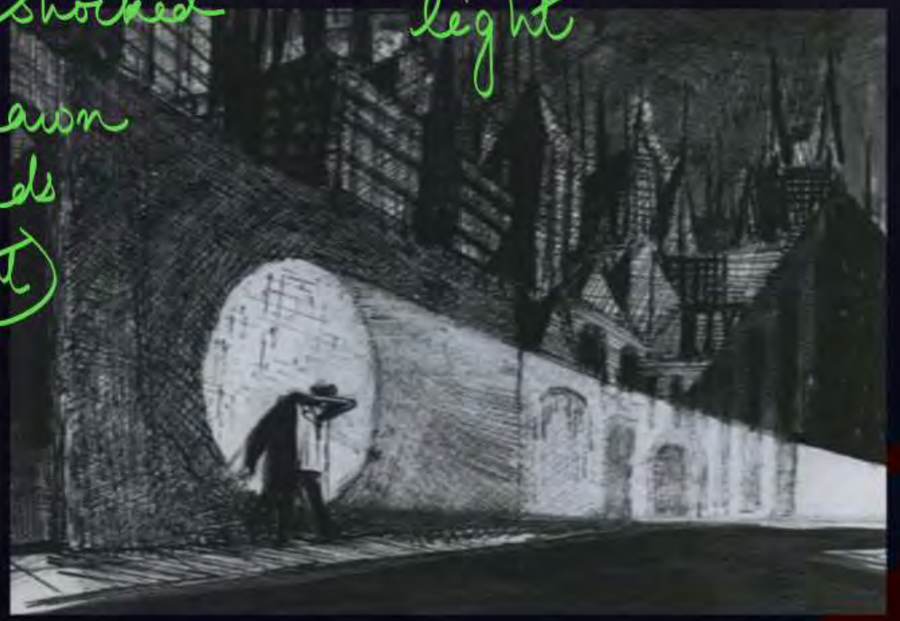
टूटा-फूटा, old

C. They were dilapidated and falling apart.

D. They were bustling with parties and social events.

Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

He turned back on a side street, circling around toward his home. He was within a block of his destination when the lone car turned a corner quite suddenly and flashed a fierce white cone of light upon him. He stood entranced, not unlike a night moth, stunned by the illumination, and then drawn toward it.





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

harsh sound of a metal clanging with a metal

A metallic voice called to him:

"Stand still. Stay where you are! Don't move!"

He halted. stopped abruptly

"Put up your hands!"

"But -" he said.

"Your hands up! Or we'll shoot!"





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

The police, of course, but what a rare, incredible thing; in a city of three million, there was only one police car left, wasn't that correct? Ever since a year ago, 2052, the election year, the force had been cut down from three cars to one. Crime was ebbing; there was no need now for the police, save for this one lone car wandering and wandering the empty streets.





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"Your name?" said the police car in a metallic whisper. He couldn't see the men in it for the bright light in his eyes.



"Leonard Mead," he said.

"Speak up!"

"Business or profession?"

"I guess you'd call me a writer."

"No profession," said the police car, as if talking to itself. The light held him fixed, like a museum specimen, needle thrust through his chest.

Specimen: an individual animal, plant, piece of a mineral, etc. used as an example of its species or type for scientific study or display



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"You might say that," said Mr. Mead. He hadn't written in years. Magazines and books didn't sell any more. Everything went on in the tomblike houses at night now, he thought, continuing his fancy. The tombs, ill-lit by television light, where the people sat like the dead, the gray or multicolored lights touching their faces, but never really touching them.

graveyard

imagination

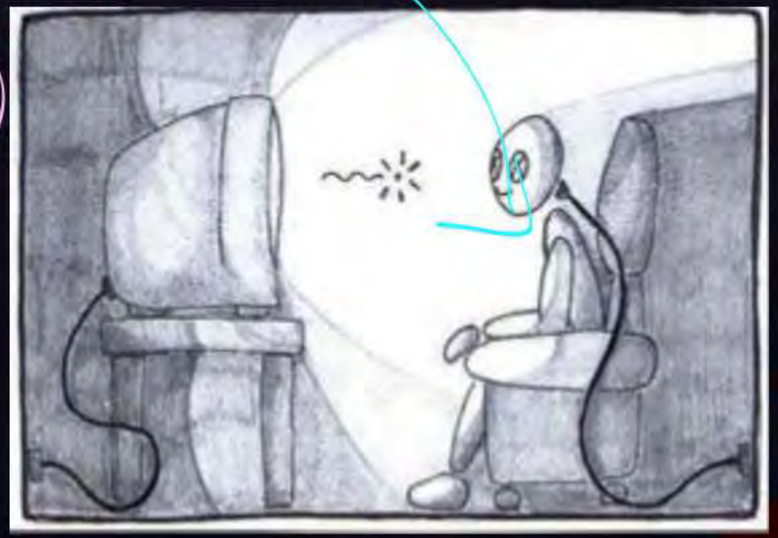
not properly lightly

ghost

physically touch

Why was writing not considered a profession?

not emotions





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"No profession," said the phonograph voice, hissing. ***"What are you doing out?"***

"Walking," said Leonard Mead.

"Walking!"

"Just walking," he said simply, but his face felt cold.

"Walking, just walking, walking?"

"Yes, sir."

"Walking where? For what?"



Phonograph voice: a phonograph is an instrument that produces sound. Here, the phonograph voice means that it was not a human voice.



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"Walking for air. Walking to see."

"Your address!"

"Eleven South Saint James Street."

"And there is air in your house, you have an air conditioner, Mr. Mead?"

"Yes."

T.V

"And you have a viewing screen in your house to see with?"

"No."

sharp

allegation, charge

"No?" There was a crackling quiet that in itself was an accusation. *"Are you married, Mr. Mead?"*

"No."



Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"Not married," said the police voice behind the fiery beam. The moon was high and clear among the stars and the houses were gray and silent.

"Nobody wanted me," said Leonard Mead with a smile.

"Don't speak unless you're spoken to!"

Leonard Mead waited in the cold night.

"Just walking, Mr. Mead?"

"Yes."

"But you haven't explained for what purpose."

"I explained; for air, and to see, and just to walk."

"Have you done this often?"

"Every night for years."





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

The police car sat in the centre of the street with its radio throat faintly humming.

Speaker throbbing

"Well, Mr. Mead," it said.

"Is that all?" he asked politely.

"Yes," said the voice. *"Here."* There was a sigh, a pop. The back door of the police car sprang wide.

"Get in."

"Wait a minute, I haven't done anything!"

"Get in."

"I protest!"

"Mr. Mead."

Humming: throbbing
Pop: appearing suddenly





Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

He walked like a man suddenly drunk. As he passed the front window of the car he looked in. As he had expected, there was no one in the front seat, no one in the car at all.

"Get in."

He put his hand to the door and peered into the back seat, which was a little cell, a little black jail with bars. It smelled of riveted steel. It smelled of harsh antiseptic; it smelled too clean and hard and metallic. There was nothing soft there.

"Now if you had a wife to give you an alibi," the iron voice said. ***"But -"***



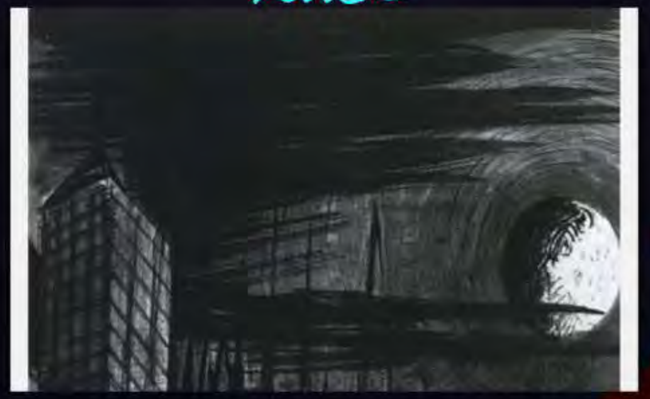
Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

"Where are you taking me?"

humming

The car hesitated, paused or rather gave a faint whirring click, as if information, somewhere, was dropping card by punch-slotted card under electric eyes. ***"To the Psychiatric Centre for Research on Regressive Tendencies."***

He got in. The door shut with a soft thud. The police car rolled through the night avenues, roads flashing its dim lights ahead.



Whirring: rattling
Regressive: Opposite of Progressive

Topic: The Pedestrian – Ray Bradbury

They passed one house on one street a moment later, one house in an entire city of houses that were dark, but this one particular house had all of its electric lights brightly lit, every window a loud yellow illumination, square and warm in the cool darkness.

"That's my house," said Leonard Mead.

Mr. Mead → House → "Warmth"

No one answered him.

The car moved down the empty river-bed streets and off away, leaving the empty streets with the empty side-walks, and no sound and no motion all the rest of the chill November night.





Topic: The Pedestrian – SPQs

#Q. Which of the following statements is NOT true of Leonard Mead?

A. He enjoyed walking the streets at night.

B. He was married to a writer.

C. He was arrested for being out of his home at night.

D. He kept all the lights in his home turned on.



Topic: The Pedestrian – SPQs

#Q. Select the option which shows the correct relationship between statements I and II.

Statement I: Mead compares walking through the empty, silent streets to walking through a graveyard.

Statement II: Mead compares the empty street to the dry riverbeds of a windless desert.

A. Statements I and II are both true.

HW

B. Statements I and II are both false.

C. Statement I is true, and Statement II is false.

D. Statement I is false, and Statement II is true



Topic: The Pedestrian – SPQs

#Q. ***"He [Mead] was within a block of his destination when the lone car turned a corner quite suddenly ..."*** **means that Mead was _____.**

A blocked by a single car when he suddenly turned the corner.

B surprised to find a block preventing the single car from turning.

C destined to be blocked suddenly by a car on a lonely street.

D close to his home when the car appeared without warning.



Topic: The Pedestrian – Summary

Read

1. The story follows Leonard Mead, a lone pedestrian walking through the empty streets.
2. Mead enjoys walking for its own sake, while everyone else relies on cars and stays indoors.
3. He notices the deserted streets, lit only by streetlights, and the houses with TV-glowing windows.
4. A police car stops Mead, questioning his presence on the street.
5. The police officer is confused by Mead's reason for walking: "For walking?“
6. Mead is arrested for "walking" and taken away.



Topic: The Pedestrian – Themes

Themes: (Society) (Mead)

1. **Conformity vs. Individuality:** Mead's walking defies societal norms.
2. **Technology-induced isolation:** People stay indoors, glued to TVs.
3. **Loss of human connection:** Mead's only interaction is with the police.
4. **Critique of modern society:** Bradbury highlights the consequences of excessive reliance on technology.

Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. ***Sometimes he would walk for hours and miles and return only at midnight to his house. And on his way, he would se the cottages sent homes with their dark windows, and it was not unequal to walking through a graveyard where only the faintest glimmers of fires light appeared in flickers behind the windows.***

1. Describe the setting of the story.
2. Who is he referred here? What did he love to do?
3. What time it was? Where was he going?
4. What would he do on reaching the corner of an intersection?
5. What type of atmosphere is described in the opening of the story?



Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. ***Hello, in there," he whispered to every house on every side as he moved. "What's up tonight on Channel 4, Channel 7, Channel 97 "Where are the cowboys rushing, and do I see the United States Cavalry over the next hill to the rescue?"***
The street was silent and long and empty, with only his shadow moving like the shadow of a hawk in mid-country. If he closed his eyes and stood very still, frozen, he could imagine himself upon the center of a plain, a wintry, windless Arizona desert with no house in a thousand miles, and only dry riverbeds, the streets, for company.

HW

1. Describe the weather that night.
2. In what mood was Mead? What did he do with the fallen leaf?
3. What did he whisper to the houses he passed on the way?
4. What does Mead's attitude towards television show?
5. How did the street look like?

Topic: The Pedestrian

#Q. *A police car sat in the center of the street with its radio throat faintly humming.*
"Well, Mr. Mead," it said.
"Is that all?" he asked politely.
"Yes," said the voice. "Here." There was a sigh, a pop. The back door of the police car sprang wide. "Get in." "Wait a minute, I haven't done anything!"
"Get in."
"I protest!"
"Mr. Mead."
He walked like a man suddenly drunk. As he passed the front window of the car he looked in. As he had expected, there was no one in the front seat, no one in the car at all.



1. What did the police car forbid Mead from doing?
2. What did the police car command Mr. Mead to do?
3. What did Mr. Mead follow the command obediently after a slight protest?
4. What had Mr. Mead expected? Was his expectation correct?
5. Describe the back seat of the police car.


Thank You